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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR /IMPROVEMENT/ REAPPEARANCE EXAMINATION

NOVEMBER 2025 FIRST SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG1DSCPEJ101 - NEWS REPORTING,

MG1DSCPJM102 - BASICS OF NEWS REPORTING

(2024 ADMISION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 Hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability

Part A

Multiple Choice Questions. Answer all questions . Each question carries 1 marks

1. Match the right description for "false balance" in a news story?

b). Presenting an issue as having equal weight when one side is significantly more credible

2. Identify the major characteristic of online news which makes it different from print and broadcast news in terms of interactivity

c). Online news uses hyperlinks and multimedia

3. Information that is freely accessible and can be reused or modified by anyone is

d). Open-source

4. Choose the appropriate definition of "attribution" in journalism.

d).). The act of assigning credit to the original source of information

5. The journalism practice based on the filtering and analysis of large data sets for the purpose of creating or elevating a news story is known as

c). Data-driven journalism

6. What does "meaningfulness" in news writing refer to?

c). The relevance and significance of the information presented

7. What distinguishes a Stringer from a full-time reporter?

a). They work independently and are paid per piece

8. What is a primary challenge of reporting for social media?

d). Need for brevity and clarity

9. Which of the following elements is essential in differentiating a TV news script from a radio news script?

a). Use of visuals

10. What is the primary advantage of sound effects in radio programs?

b). They add depth and realism to the story

[1x10 = 10]

Part B

Short Answer Type Questions (100 Words). Answer any 10 questions. Each qn carries 3 marks

11. Define freedom of expression

Freedom of expression is the fundamental human right to hold opinions without interference and to seek, receive, and impart information and ideas through any media regardless of frontiers. This right encompasses both verbal and non-verbal forms of communication, allowing individuals to engage in public discourse and critique.

12. Define a)Misinformation b)Disinformation c)Mal-information

a) Misinformation is false or inaccurate information, often spread unintentionally, while b) Disinformation is false information deliberately created and shared to cause harm or deceive. c) Mal-information is genuine information, not false, but used out of context to inflict harm on a person, organization, or country.

13. What is generative AI content?

Generative AI content is any form of media, such as text, images, video, or audio, that is created, altered, or synthesized by artificial intelligence models. These models learn patterns from vast datasets to produce novel and realistic outputs in response to user prompts.

14. Outline the steps you would take to conduct a successful interview with a public figure

General answer - To conduct a successful interview with a public figure, you should first conduct thorough research on their background and current activities to formulate relevant, probing questions. Then, establish a clear interview objective and listen actively to the subject's responses, adapting your follow-up questions to delve deeper into key topics.

15. Identify the key aspects that should be noted when covering parliament and legislature

When covering parliament and legislature, key aspects to note include the context and purpose of debates and voting, focusing on the potential impact of new legislation and policies on the public. You must also observe the power dynamics and political maneuvering between different parties and key figures to provide an insightful analysis beyond mere procedural reporting. Awareness about the parliamentary procedures and privileges are essential to avoid contempt proceedings.

16. Discuss the importance of asking open-ended questions during an interview

Asking open-ended questions is important during an interview because they encourage the interviewee to elaborate beyond a simple "yes" or "no," yielding richer, more detailed, and

spontaneous responses. This approach allows the conversation to uncover unexpected insights, personal reflections, and deeper context, ultimately enhancing the quality of the story.

17. Explain why descriptive language is important in feature news stories and how it enhances storytelling

Descriptive language is important in feature news stories because it uses sensory details to create vivid mental images and emotional resonance for the reader. This enhancement turns simple reporting into engaging storytelling, drawing the audience into the narrative and making the characters and settings feel real.

18. Discuss the importance of writing effective leads in a news story

Writing effective leads is crucial because the opening sentence or paragraph must immediately hook the reader and summarize the most vital information of the news story. A strong lead accurately reflects the main point while compelling the audience to continue reading by establishing the story's relevance and urgency.

19. Why interpretative reporting is essential in political journalism.

Interpretative reporting is essential in political journalism because it goes beyond simply stating facts to explain why political events are happening and what their long-term consequences might be. This type of reporting provides necessary context and analysis, helping the public understand the complexities of policy and political decision-making.

20. Argue whether new media has improved or hindered the quality of journalism. Use specific examples to justify your position.

General answer - New media has arguably improved the quality of journalism by democratizing news dissemination and fostering greater accountability through increased speed and citizen reporting. For example, social media allows journalists to quickly fact-check and disseminate real-time updates, although this speed also necessitates strict editorial oversight to maintain accuracy.

21. Explain how pacing can impact the viewer's experience in a stand-alone episode.

Pacing significantly impacts the viewer's experience in a stand-alone episode by controlling the rhythm and emotional intensity of the narrative. A fast pace can create excitement and suspense, while a slow pace can build atmosphere, allow for character development, and deepen the emotional impact of key moments.

22. What are some effective strategies for engaging an audience on social media?

One effective strategy for engaging an audience on social media is by consistently posting high-quality, visually appealing, and value-driven content that directly addresses their interests and encourages conversation. Furthermore, actively responding to comments and messages and running interactive polls or Q&A sessions can foster a sense of community and direct participation.

Part C

Essay Type Questions (450 Words). Answer any 2 questions. Each question carries 15 marks

23. Classify the types of news based on geographical location using relevant examples.

News can be broadly classified by geographical scope into local, national, and international news, each focusing on events within a specific boundary. Local news, such as a story about a new town council ordinance, focuses on community affairs, while national news covers issues affecting an entire country, like a presidential election. International news reports on significant events occurring globally, such as treaty negotiations between multiple countries.

24. Analyze the legal challenges presented by AI-generated media (audio, video, images) that realistically depict non-existent events.

General answer - AI-generated media depicting non-existent events presents significant legal challenges, primarily concerning defamation, copyright, and the right of publicity. If this media falsely portrays a person in a negative light, it can lead to defamation lawsuits and, if a likeness is used without permission, may violate their right of publicity. Furthermore, the use of existing copyrighted works to train AI models and generate new content raises complex issues regarding fair use and intellectual property infringement.

25. . Describe how you would prepare to cover an important political speech of a national leader

To cover an important political speech, I would first conduct thorough research on the leader's past statements, current policy positions, and the context surrounding the speech to anticipate key themes. During the speech, I would actively listen for major announcements, shifts in tone, or quotes that summarize the speech's main message, while also observing the audience's reaction. Finally, I would immediately begin analyzing the speech's significance and its potential political impact to frame my reporting accurately.

26. Assess the influence of travel reporting in promoting tourism on local economies.

General answer - Travel reporting exerts a strong influence on promoting tourism by generating curiosity and authentic interest in destinations, directly translating to increased visitor numbers. When journalists highlight unique cultural experiences, local businesses, and sustainable practices, they can help direct tourism spending to local economies rather than just large chains. This exposure can be vital for developing regions, supporting jobs, and funding the preservation of natural and historical sites.